



CUREFOODS (CLOUD KITCHEN)

• ANKIT NAGORI, FOUNDER

> **KEY INVESTORS** Three State Ventures, Iron Pillar, Accel, Chiratae

> **FUNDING** \$125 million so far

► In 2010, Ankit Nagori transitioned from his social media venture, YouthPad, to become an early employee at Flipkart. After rising to Chief Business Officer and leaving Flipkart in 2016, Nagori co-founded wellness venture Curefit with Mukesh Bansal, the founder of e-commerce company, Myntra. Four years later, wanting to go solo, Nagori carved out Curefoods, a food-oriented business. During Covid-19, Nagori noticed a big demand for food delivery and jumped at the opportunity. As time rolled on, the company shifted gears to a Thrasio-like model, snagging cloud kitchen brands in different cities and giving them a hand in growing their businesses. In FY22, Curefoods generated ₹89 crore in operational revenue while losses stood at ₹71 crore. Now the second-largest cloud kitchen player in India, Curefoods is aiming for Ebitda (earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation, and amortisation) profitability in 2024, with an IPO planned within the next 24-to-36 months. **BT**

— BY BINU PAUL

CYBERNETICS LABORATORY (VISUAL OBJECT INTELLIGENCE PLATFORM & DEEP-TECH COMPANY)

• GOKUL N.A., FOUNDER • NIKHIL RAMASWAMY, CO-FOUNDER

> **KEY INVESTORS** Speciale Invest, GrowX Ventures and Arali Ventures

> **FUNDING** Pre-Series A in 2022 funding of \$4.5 million, led by Speciale Invest and GrowX Ventures; Seed round of about \$775,000 in 2019, led by Speciale Invest & Arali Ventures

► **OVER THE PAST** few decades automation technology has scaled greater heights. However, achievements in the fields of automating physical tasks remains limited. And that is where two friends saw a major business opportunity. So Gokul N.A., Founder, and Nikhil Ramaswamy, Co-founder of Cybernetics Laboratory (CynLr), took the plunge in 2019 to build a platform that allows robots to be intuitive in handling objects. The “journey has been long”, as Gokul puts it. It all started with their first stint at the American multinational National Instruments, focussed on automated test equipment and virtual instrumentation software, in Bengaluru in 2011. CynLr is about to become a \$2-million turnover company by end-2024 and expects to raise it to at least \$5 million in 2025. As Gokul emphasises, the philosophy behind CynLr is to bring automation to its basic principles, making physical tasks efficient. **BT**

— BY ARNAB DUTTA



► **“A FOUNDER HAS** to be everything. We have to wear multiple hats in a day,” says Darwinbox Co-founder Jayant Paleti. He would know. The Hyderabad-based HRtech start-up is taking on legacy multibillion dollar players such as SAP and Oracle by providing cloud-based human resources management software for 2.2 million employees across 850-odd companies such as Vedanta, L&T Metro Rail, Adani Wilmar, Swiggy, Zepto and more. Set up in 2015 by three friends, Paleti, Chaitanya Peddi and Rohit Chennamaneni, it became a unicorn in 2022—the 84th Indian start-up to be valued over a billion dollars. The founders have placed tremendous emphasis on having a good, reliable team with a high level of agency and initia-